

CLASS - 12th

SUBJECT - ENGLISH

PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

CLASS 12TH BIHAR BOARD – ENGLISH (RAINBOW PART 2)

POETRY CHAPTER 3: NOW THE LEAVES ARE FALLING FAST (BY W.H. AUDEN)

 CHAPTER SUMMARY (IN 50 WORDS)

"Now the Leaves Are Falling Fast" is a remarkable lyric by W.H. Auden. Through the metaphor of autumn leaves, the poet depicts human old age, frustration, and the inevitability of death. He highlights the isolation of modern human life but offers hope through nature's ultimate peace.

 12 IMPORTANT SHORT SUBJECTIVE QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

Q1. What does the poet mean by the phrase "leaves are falling fast"?

Ans: The phrase metaphorically means that human beings are growing old and moving towards their death very rapidly, just like leaves fall quickly from trees in autumn.

Q2. What are the "Prms" mentioned in the poem, and what do they roll on for?

Ans: The "Prms" are baby carriages. They signify the continuity of human life. While the old generation dies, the new generation keeps moving forward on the path of life.

Q3. Who are the "Whispering Neighbours" in the poem?

Ans: The "Whispering Neighbours" are the messengers or agents of death (like the Grim Reaper) who stay around living humans to pluck them away from the real world.

Q4. How do the whispering neighbours pluck us from our "real delight"?

Ans: They pluck us from our real delight by bringing physical diseases, old age, and death, which separate us from the joy and pleasures of living.

Q5. What does the poet mean when he says, "Active hands must freeze"?

Ans: He means that when a person dies, their living, hard-working, and active body parts become completely cold, stiff, and motionless on a lonely grave.

Q6. Who are the "Trolls" mentioned in the text, and what do they do?

Ans: Trolls are wicked, ugly creatures from Scandinavian mythology. In the poem, they represent cruel, modern human beings who exploit and abuse others.

Q7. Why is the "Nightingale" dumb or silent in the poem?



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Ans: The nightingale is silent because the beautiful elements of nature are shocked by the moral decay and misery of human beings. No one comes to save them.

Q8. What is the source of hope or consolation at the end of the poem?

Ans: The source of hope is the cold, beautiful mountain waterfall. Its white water provides a final blessing and peaceful travelers' rest to dying humans.

Q9. Why does human life become full of frustration in old age?

Ans: Life becomes full of frustration because of loneliness, physical weakness, lack of emotional support, and the constant fear of approaching death.

Q10. How are the dead people left "hundreds in the wooden track"?

Ans: The dead are placed in wooden coffins and carried along a narrow path towards their graves, followed by other mortal human beings.

Q11. Why is W.H. Auden's poetry described as a "serious game"?

Ans: His poetry is called a serious game because it combines strict, playful intellectual language with deeply serious social, political, and moral realities of life.

Q12. What is the central theme of this poem?

Ans: The central theme is the transient nature of human life, the frustration of modern civilization, and the final spiritual relief provided by nature's cycle.

 35 OBJECTIVE QUESTIONS (QUESTION & OPTIONS IN SINGLE LINE)

1. 'Now the Leaves Are Falling Fast' is composed by: (A) Walt Whitman (B) W.H. Auden (C) John Keats (D) T.S. Eliot
2. W.H. Auden won the prestigious Pulitzer Prize in the year 1948 for his book: (A) The Age of Anxiety (B) Leaves of Grass (C) Songs and Sonnets (D) The Earth
3. W.H. Auden was a poet, dramatist, critic, and translator originally from: (A) America (B) England / Britain (C) India (D) Ireland
4. Auden left England permanently in 1939 to settle down in: (A) France (B) USA / America (C) Germany (D) Japan
5. The poem 'Now the Leaves Are Falling Fast' represents a deeply _____ lyric.: (A) happy (B) pessimistic-cum-optimistic (C) purely romantic (D) comedic
6. "Now the leaves are falling _____ .": (A) slow (B) fast (C) down (D) green
7. Nurse's flowers will not last, and the graves are gone to the: (A) forest (B) past (C) mountain (D) river
8. "And the prams go _____ on.": (A) stopping (B) rolling (C) jumping (D) breaking
9. The messengers of death are described in the poem as _____ neighbours.: (A) shouting (B)



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whispering (C) helping (D) sleeping

10. The whispering neighbours pluck us from the real: (A) sorrow (B) delight / joy (C) wealth (D) home

11. "And the active hands must _____.": (A) burn (B) freeze (C) work (D) dance

12. After death, our hands lie lonely on the separate: (A) beds (B) knees (C) tables (D) houses

13. "Hundreds in the wooden track, arms stiffly lifted to _____.": (A) fight (B) reprove / scold (C) pray (D) wave

14. Dead people are carried out in boxes or coffins made of: (A) steel (B) wood (C) iron (D) glass

15. In the forest, the ugly and wicked creatures running for food are: (A) birds (B) trolls (C) lions (D) ghosts

16. The trolls run scolding through the leafless: (A) garden (B) wood / forest (C) street (D) park

17. Which bird is described as "dumb" or silent in the text?: (A) Cuckoo (B) Nightingale (C) Sparrow (D) Peacock

18. No _____ will come to help the miserable humans in the forest.: (A) doctor (B) angel (C) teacher (D) king

19. "Cold, _____, list the mountain's head.": (A) green (B) impossible (C) high (D) white

20. The white waterfall could bless travelers in their last: (A) sleep (B) distress / journey (C) flight (D) meeting

21. The falling of leaves symbolizes the arrival of which season?: (A) Summer (B) Autumn / Winter (C) Spring (D) Monsoon

22. The word 'Prms' represents a vehicle used for carrying: (A) heavy luggage (B) babies / infants (C) old men (D) soldiers

23. The poem showcases the deep gaps and frustrations in modern human: (A) factories (B) relationships / life (C) schools (D) politics

24. W.H. Auden's work is divided into two phases: the English phase and the: (A) French phase (B) American phase (C) Indian phase (D) German phase

25. "Starving through the leafless wood" shows the scarcity of: (A) weapons (B) food and life resources (C) money (D) clothes

26. The attitude of the modern world towards the dying is shown as completely: (A) helpful (B) cold and indifferent (C) celebratory (D) angry

27. The line "And the nightingale is dumb" signifies a loss of: (A) wealth (B) art, music, and joy (C) trees (D) cash

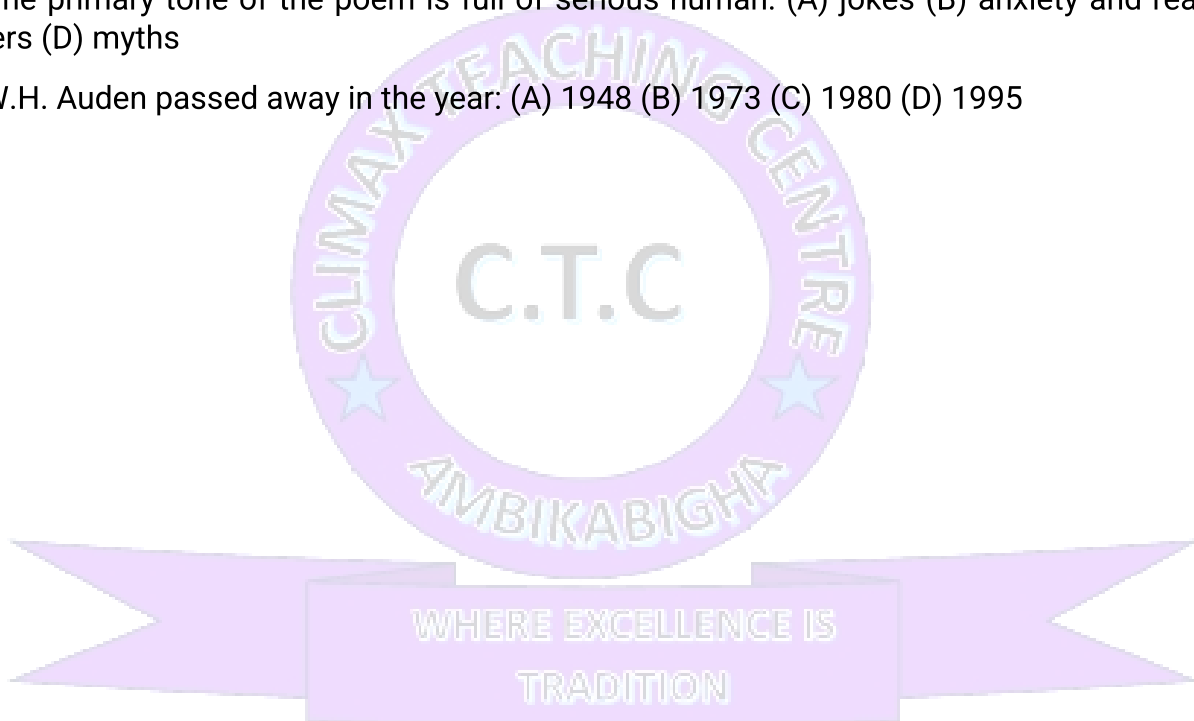
28. Human life, according to Auden, is a rapid march towards the: (A) palace (B) grave / end (C) university (D) office

29. "False attitude of love" refers to human: (A) absolute honesty (B) hypocrisy and selfishness (C) true devotion (D) history



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30. The color of the mountain's freezing waterfall is: (A) black (B) white (C) red (D) yellow
31. Auden views poetry fundamentally as a serious technique or a: (A) political weapon (B) serious game (C) business option (D) time waste
32. The word 'reprove' used in the text means to express: (A) love (B) disapproval / scolding (C) joy (D) fear
33. The travelers mentioned in the last stanza are people near their: (A) birthday (B) death / final hours (C) marriage (D) job
34. The primary tone of the poem is full of serious human: (A) jokes (B) anxiety and reality (C) super powers (D) myths
35. W.H. Auden passed away in the year: (A) 1948 (B) 1973 (C) 1980 (D) 1995



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